

Neurological N-02 Seizure BLS

Revised 3/1/2000

PRIORITIES:

- ABCs
- Airway maintenance, support respiration, prevent body injury
- Determine degree of physiologic distress, possible cause of seizure
- Assess and document course of seizure
- Assure an advanced life support response
- Obtain patient history – note number of seizures and time interval of seizure activity

General Seizures

Tonic, clonic movements followed by a period of unconsciousness (post-ictal period). Usually history of prior seizures on medication, alcohol withdrawal..

1. Ensure a patent airway (use bite block if it can be easily inserted)
 - a. Insert oropharyngeal/nasopharyngeal airway as tolerated;
 - b. Assist ventilation as needed;
 - c. Suction as necessary.
1. Be prepared to support ventilation with appropriate airway adjuncts;
2. OXYGEN THERAPY – Begin oxygen at 6 liters/ minute by nasal cannula or 10 liters/minute by mask. If there is a history of Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease (COPD), observe for respiratory depression and support respirations as needed. **DO NOT** withhold oxygen from a patient in cardiorespiratory distress because of a history of COPD.
3. Protect patient from injury by placing padding appropriately. Move objects away from patient. Do not forcibly restrain the patient;
4. Immobilize the spine in trauma or the suspicion of trauma;
5. Position on left side if no trauma;
6. Assist advanced life support personnel with patient packaging and movement to ambulance;
7. Consider:
 - Cooling with moist towels if febrile;;
 - Diabetic hypoglycemia
 - Protect the patient from further injury;
 - Provide for patient privacy if possible.

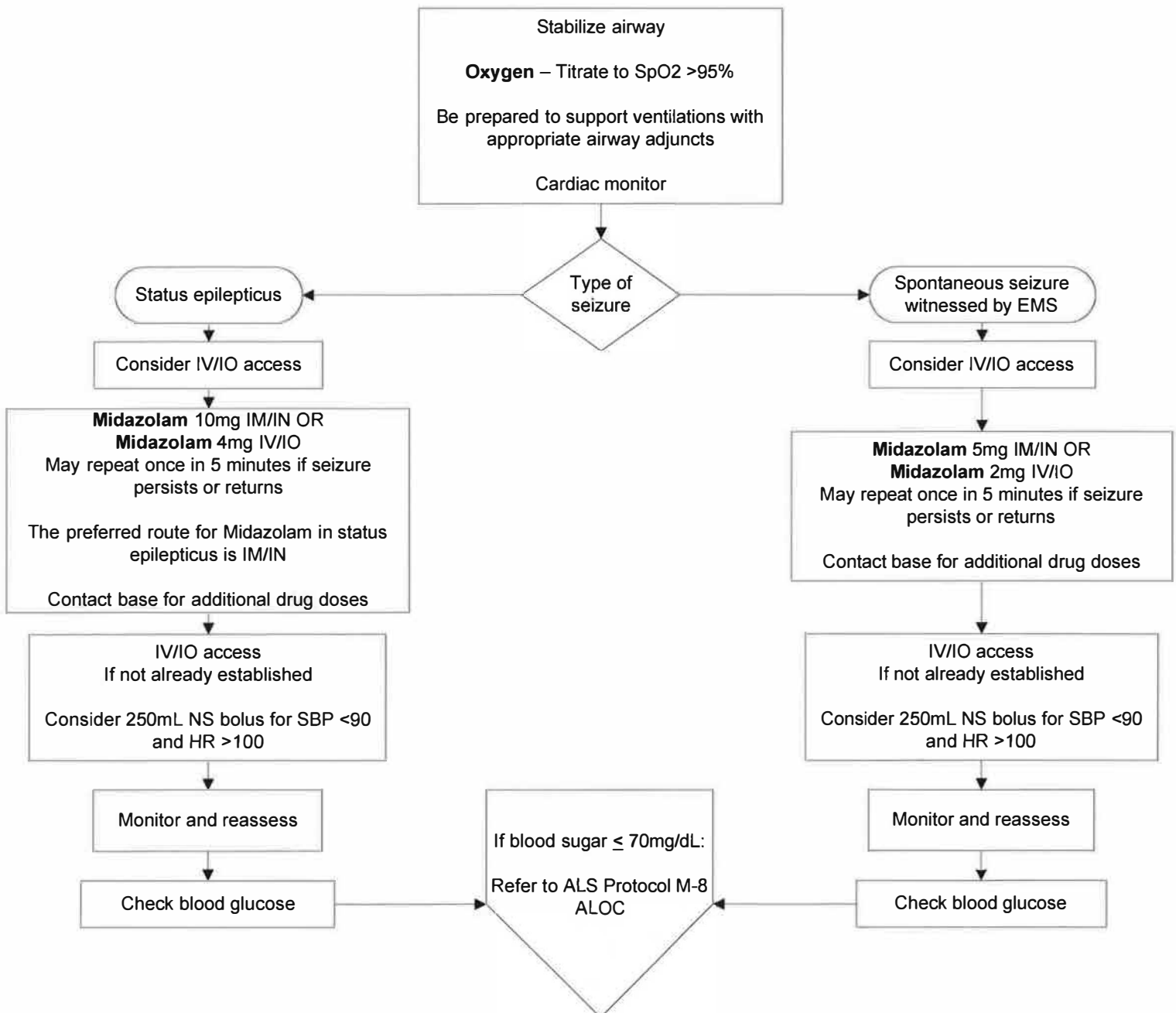
Neurological N-02 Seizure

Priorities

Airway/Breathing/Circulation
 Maintain airway and support breathing
 Prevent bodily injury
 Determine degree of physiologic distress and possible cause of seizure
 Assess and document course of seizure
 Early transport
 Early contact of receiving hospital

Definitions

Status Epilepticus – Single seizure lasting >5 minutes or two or more seizures without a return to baseline between seizures



DISRUPTED COMMUNICATIONS

In the event of a "disrupted communications" situation where a base hospital physician CANNOT be contacted for orders, Solano County Paramedics MAY NOT utilize the portions of this protocol requiring base physician orders AND must transport to the closest receiving facility.